



Food and Agriculture
Organization of the
United Nations

Setting the stage

Leveraging Evidence for Effective Anticipatory Action



Anticipatory Action - Definition

Anticipatory action is defined as acting ahead of a predicted hazardous event to prevent or reduce impacts on lives and livelihoods and humanitarian needs before they fully unfold. This works best when activities as well as triggers or decision-making rules are pre-agreed, and decisions are made to guarantee the fast release of pre-arranged funding.

Outcome Document - Grand Bargain Caucus on Scaling up Anticipatory Action (2024)

The Anticipatory Action journey

International Journal of Disaster Risk Science
<https://doi.org/10.1007/s13753-026-00709-x>

www.ijdrs.com
www.springer.com/13753

PERSPECTIVE



The Long Road to Acting Ahead: Lessons from the Evolution of Early Warning Systems and Anticipatory Action

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1960s–80s

National early warning systems scale up

2011 and 2015/16

Somalia famine and El Nino – failure to act on forecast

2015

Forecast-based financing

2016 →

Dedicated anticipatory action funds

2018–2020

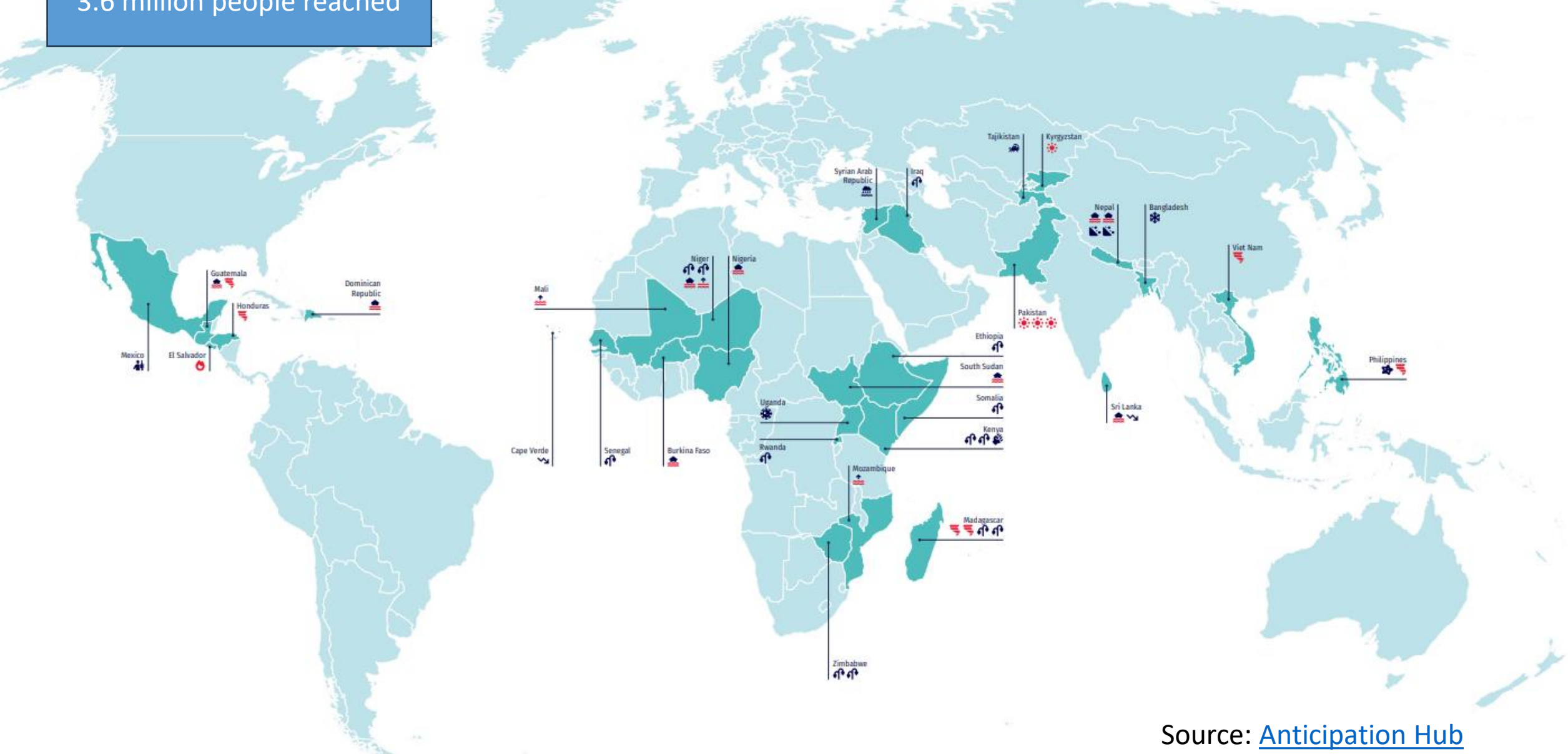
Global coordination (AATF, Anticipation Hub, OCHA)

2020 →

Government ownership (REAP, EW4All)

47 activations
3.6 million people reached

AA activations in 2022



Source: [Anticipation Hub](#)

Hazard types

Figure 2.
Activations in 2024:
in numbers

In
2024 ...

* Not all actions require the same level of financial input to reach people; these figures should therefore not be used for cost-per-person calculations.

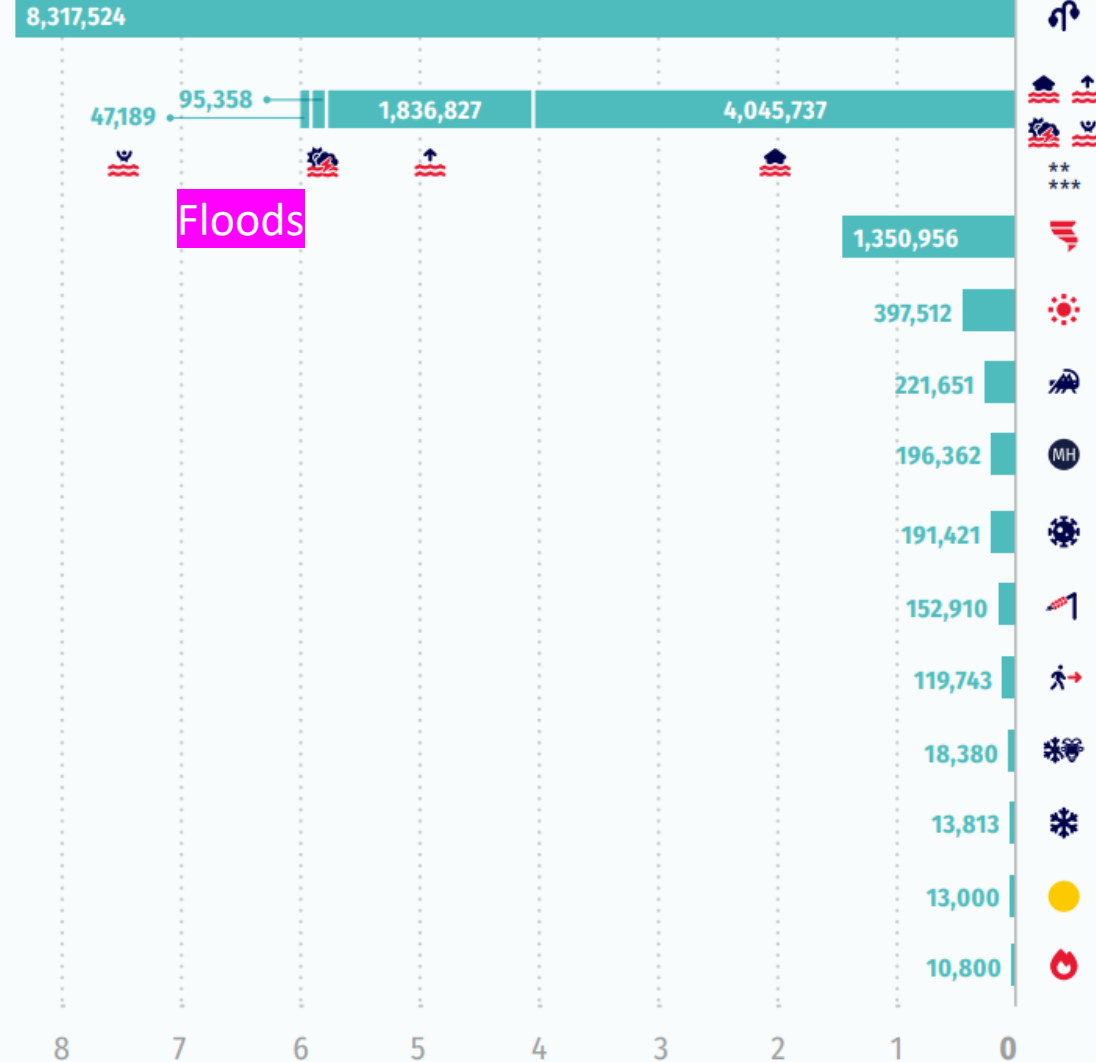
** The total amount of financing released is lower than the amount in 2023 (198 million US dollars), despite an increase in the number of activations. This could be due to a higher number of small-scale activations and fewer large-scale activations.

*** This should be considered as a



In 2024, **17 million people worldwide** were reached through activations.*

Drought



Source: [Anticipation Hub](#)

Anticipatory Action work at FAO, as of 2025



50 AA plans/protocols (from 2 in 2016) in place in 32 countries, including 18 inter-agency frameworks facilitated by OCHA

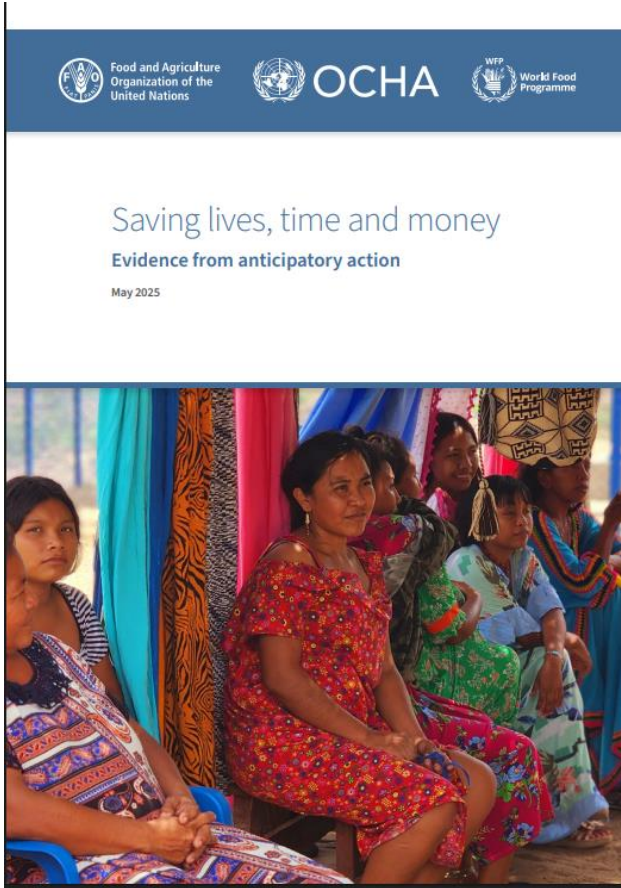


About **USD 60M** (FAO SFERA, CERF...) in the last three years to protect about **5 million rural people** ahead of forecast hazards

Anticipatory Action is integrated into **FAO's Strategic Framework 2022-31**

Joint evidence

[Saving lives, time and money: Evidence from anticipatory action](#) (FAO, OCHA, WFP - May 2025)



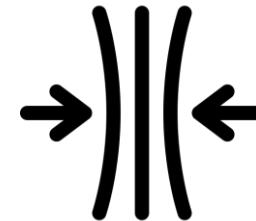
- **7:1 ratio** – avoided disaster impact
- **Half the cost** of emergency response



- Maintained **child nutrition**
- **Sustained** acceptable levels of **food consumption**

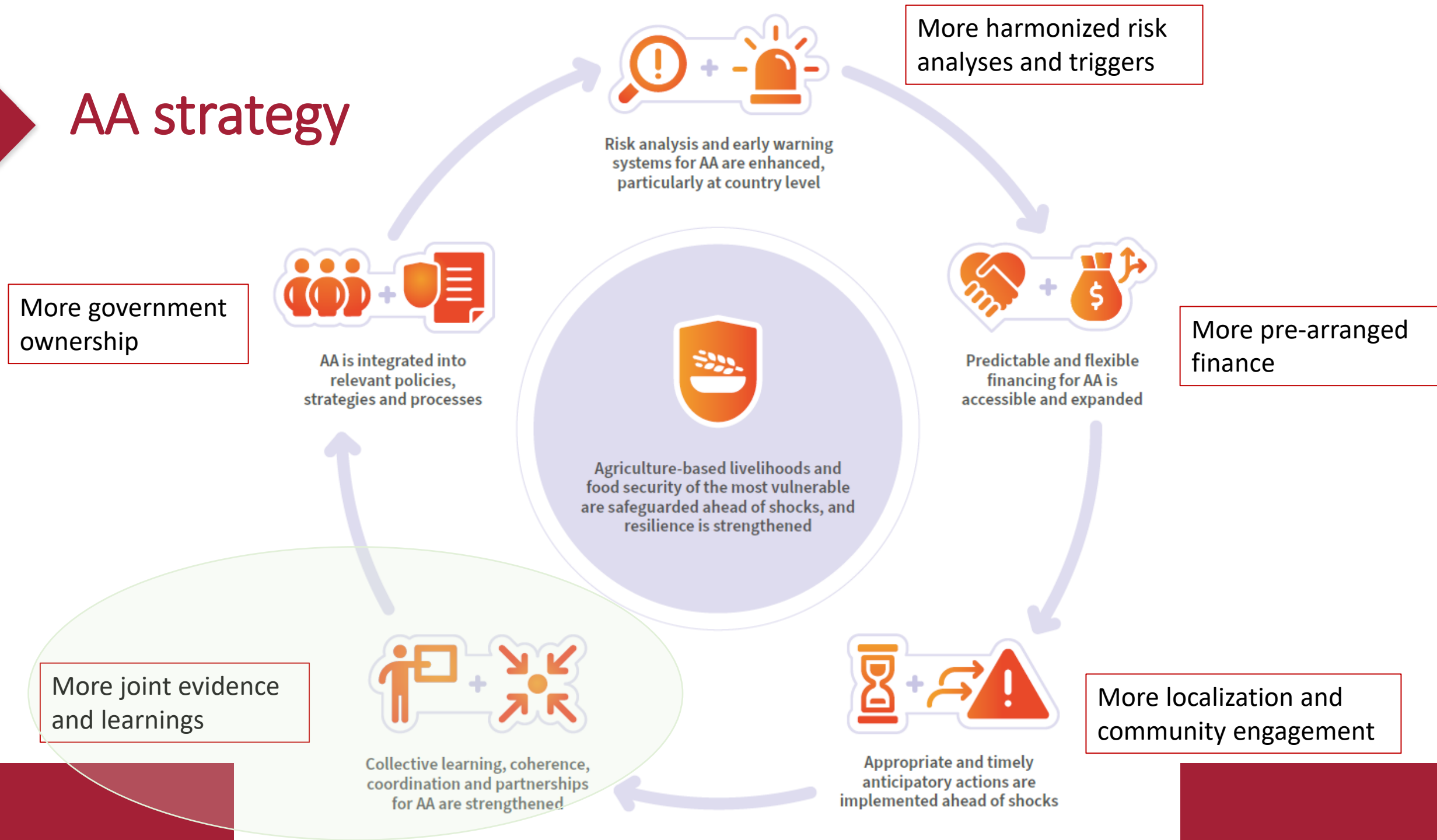


- **48 hours** after flood forecast
- **6 to 10** months before response



- Avoided **debt traps**
- Increased **social cohesion**
- Boosted **self-confidence**

AA strategy





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A woman wearing a vibrant, patterned headscarf in shades of red, yellow, and white is seated outdoors. She is positioned next to several large, white, conical sacks, likely containing food aid. In the background, other people wearing colorful traditional clothing are visible, and a white sack with the word 'Food' printed on it is partially seen in the lower right corner. The entire scene is framed by a white geometric border.

THANK YOU!

Leveraging Evidence for Effective Anticipatory Action

DAY 1 — 20 April 2026 | FAO Headquarters, Austria Room

TIME	SESSION	SPEAKERS	MODERATOR
09:00–09:30	Welcome and Registration		
09:30–09:55	Opening Remarks: The Evidence Imperative for Anticipatory Action	David Laborde (ESA) Rein Paulsen (OER) Inger Brodal (Norad) Sarah Klassen (FCDO)	
09:55–10:15	Setting the Stage: Objectives and Approach	Antonio Scognamillo Niccolò Lombardi	
10:15–11:15	Keynote: Evaluating What Matters – Evidence Standards in Crisis Contexts	Karen Macours (PSE)	Nicholas Sitko
11:15–11:30	Coffee Break		
11:30–13:00	Evidence in Action: Impact Evaluation Case Studies	K. Khan Niazi, G. Baliki (ISDC) C. Gros (Climate Ctr), A. Pople (WB) J. Waidler (WFP), T. Delbiso (FAO)	Erin O'Brien
13:00–14:00	Lunch Break		
14:00–15:30	Turning Analytics into Timely Action: Decision Support for AA	A. Cabezas (Oxford), R. Spencer (FAO) L. Rossi (UNDRR), L. Peiser (NSL) P. Zimmer (WB), N. Marsland (OER) D. Piovani (WFP), S. von der Maase (PRIO)	Andrea Cattaneo
15:30–15:45	Coffee Break		
15:45–17:15	Breaking Down Silos: Coordination, Data Sharing & Joint Evaluations	H. Paulose (OCHA), J. Mason (WFP) R. Cavatassi (WB), S. Burrone (FAO) S. Merner (J-PAL), C. Gros (Clim. Ctr)	Katherine Kemp
17:15	Networking Aperitivo @ FAO Rooftop		

Leveraging Evidence for Effective Anticipatory Action

DAY 2 — 21 April 2026 | FAO Headquarters, Austria Room

TIME	SESSION	SPEAKERS	MODERATOR
09:00–09:15	Welcoming Coffee		
09:15–09:30	Opening Remarks: From Evidence to Action	Clemencia Cosentino (OED)	
09:30–11:00	AA for Agriculture & Food Security: Voices from the Field	R. Vinet (OER), A. Memon (FAOSO) S. Montembault (FAOAF) M. Amling (WHH), M. Ogle (IFRC) E. Cazou (START), A. Humphrey (MC)	Chiara Melluci
11:00–11:15	Coffee Break		
11:15–12:45	Members' Perspectives & Evidence Use: What Do We Still Need?	Katrin Planta (GFFO), Inger Brodal (Norad) Sarah Klassen (FCDO), U-Nichols Manalo (Philippines) Annette Schneegans (EU), H.E. Lieven De La Marche (Belgium)	Dunja Dujanovic
12:45–13:45	Lunch Break		
13:45–14:45	Financing Foresight: Scaling AA through Risk Financing	D. Pfister (OCHA), Y. Matinshan (ODG) M. Keil (SFERA), E. Wahlstrom (UNDRR) M. Dubreuil (WFP)	Luca Parodi
14:45–15:45	Aligning Evidence and Action: Donor, Implementer & Researcher	Dean Karlan (IPA)	Clemencia Cosentino
15:45–16:00	Coffee Break		
16:00–17:00	What's Next? Progress, Gaps and Way Forward	Antonio Scognamillo Niccolò Lombardi	
17:00–17:30	Closing Remarks and Way Forward	Maximo Torero (recording) David Laborde (ESA) Maxwell Sibhensana (OER)	